

ENGLISH

This section contains 22 questions.

The time allotted is 20 minutes.

The following section contains three types of questions: Sentence Completion, Restatement and Reading Comprehension. Each question is followed by four possible responses. Choose the response which best answers the question and mark its number in the appropriate place on the answer sheet.

Sentence Completions (Questions 1-8)

This part consists of sentences with a word or words missing in each. For each question, choose the answer which best completes the sentence.

1. Jackals can live up to 10 years in the wild and up to 16 years in _____.
 (1) anxiety
 (2) severity
 (3) captivity
 (4) royalty

2. Landscape architect Hoichi Kurisu _____ nearly two years of his life to designing the Morikami Museum and Japanese Gardens in Delray Beach, Florida.
 (1) devoted
 (2) exposed
 (3) composed
 (4) obeyed

3. A large _____ includes, among other instruments, violins, French horns, and drums.
 (1) vehicle
 (2) mechanism
 (3) orchestra
 (4) experiment

4. When 13th-century explorer Marco Polo first _____ rhinoceroses, he mistakenly thought that the animals were unicorns.
 (1) encountered
 (2) deceived
 (3) appointed
 (4) consulted

5. A _____ characteristic of the brown hyena is its unusually thick coat.

- (1) persuasive
- (2) distinguishing
- (3) superstitious
- (4) revolutionary

6. George Orwell's *Animal Farm* is a stinging _____ of the Soviet Union's corruption of socialist ideals.

- (1) critique
- (2) invasion
- (3) phase
- (4) notion

7. Designated a national landmark in 1969, The Plaza _____ the most famous hotel in New York City.

- (1) is arguably
- (2) was argumentative
- (3) is an argument to
- (4) argues for

8. After a long _____, Canadian singer Leonard Cohen staged a comeback in 2008.

- (1) latitude
- (2) predicament
- (3) incentive
- (4) hiatus

Restatements (Questions 9-12)
This part consists of several sentences, each followed by four possible ways of restating the main idea of that sentence in different words. For each question, choose the one restatement which best expresses the meaning of the original sentence.

9. Katie Mulcahey was the only person fined for violating a short-lived 1908 New York City ordinance that prohibited women from smoking in public.

- (1) New York City's 1908 ban against women smoking in public was overturned shortly after Katie Mulcahey was fined for violating the law.
- (2) Katie Mulcahey was the first person, but not the last – to defy a New York City law that made it illegal for women to smoke in public.
- (3) In 1908, Katie Mulcahey was fined for protesting against a New York City regulation barring women from smoking in public.
- (4) During the brief time that New York City banned women from smoking in public, just one person – Katie Mulcahey – was fined for breaking the law.

10. A sapphire rush in the late 1990s transformed the sleepy village of Ilakaka, Madagascar, into a boomtown.

- (1) The quiet village of Ilakaka became a thriving town in the late 1990s, when many people were drawn to the area by the discovery of sapphires.
- (2) The small town of Ilakaka has expanded greatly since becoming one of the world's main sources of sapphires in the late 1990s.
- (3) A sapphire rush in Madagascar in the late 1990s led to the establishment of several villages and towns, including Ilakaka.
- (4) Once the mining of sapphires in Ilakaka came to an end in the late 1990s, the village's population declined drastically.

11. In 1873, a custom-built gallery was created to house Michelangelo's *David*, which had stood outside until then.

- (1) Michelangelo's *David* was moved indoors to a gallery constructed especially for it in 1873.
- (2) The indoor gallery that now houses Michelangelo's *David* dates back to 1873.
- (3) Michelangelo's *David*, originally intended to stand outside, was moved indoors in 1873.
- (4) Until 1873, Michelangelo's *David* was exhibited outside the gallery in which it is currently displayed.

12. Pummeled by more than its share of natural disasters, Japan has time and again demonstrated resilience in the face of adversity.

- (1) Japan has repeatedly overcome hardships caused by the devastating natural disasters to which it is prone.
- (2) Japan's expertise in managing the destruction resulting from natural disasters has been hard earned.
- (3) Though the country is plagued by natural disasters, Japan's infrastructure remains robust.
- (4) Japan's capacity to rebound from catastrophe has decreased with each successive natural disaster.

Reading Comprehension

This part consists of two passages, each followed by several related questions. For each question, choose the most appropriate answer based on the text.

Text I (Questions 13-17)

- (1) In today's world of fast, efficient communication such as email and WhatsApp, why would anyone bother with stamps and envelopes? Indeed, "snail mail" – as the regular postal system is often called – may eventually become obsolete. Some post offices have radically streamlined the services they provide or have closed altogether. However, a few are flourishing – thanks to their surprising locations.

- (10) One of the most unusual post offices is found in Vanuatu, a country comprising many islands in the South Pacific Ocean. Located in Hideaway Island Marine Sanctuary, the world's first underwater post office lies fifty meters offshore and three meters below the water's surface. A flag flown above the site announces when the postal workers trained divers who swim to work wearing scuba equipment – are on duty. An estimated 100,000 tourists have used the post office since its opening in 2003. Visitors who choose to dive can purchase waterproof postcards on shore and swim out to mail them (non-divers have the option of placing them in a mailbox located in a hotel). Vanuatu Post encourages visitors to literally look below the surface.

- (15) Another postal facility that owes its fame to its location is the Penguin Post Office, the most popular tourist attraction in Antarctica. Run by the United Kingdom Antarctic Heritage Trust, the world's southernmost post office is situated at Port Lockroy, on tiny Wiencke Island, 1100 kilometers from the tip of South America. The post office operates only during the four months of summer, when thousands of tourists arrive on cruise ships to enjoy Antarctica's natural beauty, watch Port Lockroy's huge colony of gentoo penguins in action, and send postcards 80,000 annually – to relatives and friends back home. The four-person staff is replaced every year. Despite the remote location, cold weather, minimal salary, and crude living conditions, more than fifty people eagerly apply each year to the Heritage Trust for the privilege of undergoing this singular experience.

Questions

13. What do the two post offices described in the text have in common?

- (1) They are in convenient locations.
 (2) They provide unique experience.
 (3) They may soon have to close.
 (4) They have streamlined their services.

14. In line 3, "become **obsolete**" is **closest in** meaning to -

- (1) greatly **improve**
 (2) **no longer exist**
 (3) **spread to new places**
 (4) look **different**

15. The **main purpose** of the second **paragraph** is to **describe** -

- (1) the **Hideaway Island Marine Sanctuary**
 (2) some **of Vanuatu's tourist attractions**
 (3) the **world's smallest post office**
 (4) a **post office that is not on land**

16. It can be **inferred** that **Vanuatu Post** offers **tourists** the **opportunity** to -

- (1) learn **how** to **dive**
 (2) **buy** **scuba equipment**
 (3) **visit** many **islands**
 (4) see **underwater life**

17. **Based on the information in the last paragraph, which of the following statements about the Penguin Post Office is true?**

- (1) It is not **difficult** to **find people who want to work there.**
 (2) **Its workers are well paid.**
 (3) **Its staff helps look after the penguin colony.**
 (4) It **changes its location in the winter.**

שאלה
Text II (Questions 18-22)

- (1) Science fiction writers have superb imaginations. They transport us to parallel universes and offer startling visions of what the future might hold. But just how accurate have the fantasies of writers turned out to be?

- (5) Many depictions of futuristic inventions that appear in works of science fiction were remarkably accurate in anticipating technological developments. In his 1865 novel *From the Earth to the Moon*, Jules Verne envisioned a flight into space. Using his knowledge of engineering, he described, among other things, a "moon gun" similar in principle to the rockets that launched spaceships to the moon a century later. Edward Bellamy, in his 1888 novel *Looking Backward*, wrote of people using something akin to today's debit cards instead of money. In George Orwell's novel 1984, published in 1949, the ability of the all-controlling dictator to track citizens' every movement foreshadowed the 24-hour surveillance capabilities available today. Other innovations that have become features of everyday life – such as iPads, cell phones, smartwatches, and the internet – were all described long ago in one form or another in works of science fiction.

- (15) Clearly, not everything concocted by science fiction writers has become reality. Time travel, cities on other planets, and robot rebellions remain for the time being in the realm of imagination. For science fiction writers, however, accuracy is not necessarily the point. As author Larry Niven explains, their aim is to imagine all possibilities. This, he notes, is not the same as attempting to predict the future.

שאלה
Questions

18. The main purpose of the text is to -

- (1) examine the place of science fiction in literature
(2) compare the works of several well-known science fiction authors
(3) discuss how accurate the depictions of science fiction writers have been
(4) present some important features of science fiction

19. Which of the following is not mentioned in the second paragraph as a development imagined by science fiction writers?

- (1) rockets
- (2) money
- (3) tracking devices
- (4) the internet

20. In line 12, "foreshadowed" could best be replaced by -

- (1) transported
- (2) anticipated
- (3) launched
- (4) surveyed

21. It can be inferred from the text that science fiction writers want to ____ not ____.

- (1) entertain; make predictions
- (2) frighten readers; make them think about what is possible
- (3) influence the future of technology; sell a lot of books
- (4) shape reality; describe imaginary worlds

22. Based on the information in the text, which of the following would least likely be the plot of a science fiction novel?

- (1) A creature from another planet visits Earth.
- (2) When global warming threatens to destroy life on Earth in 2099, a group of young people set out to save the world.
- (3) An army led by the king of ancient Egypt conquers another empire.
- (4) Machines built by a mad scientist take over the world.